

The Boston Globe

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THURSDAY, JANUARY 23, 2025

Pushing back on Trump threats

Religious leaders hail bishop for speaking out in front of president

By Sean Cotter
GLOBE STAFF
and Emily Spatz
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

For centuries, American religious leaders have staked out positions on controversial issues, from slavery to Prohibition to abortion to civil rights. While much like the American public, the religious community is politically diverse: the longstanding norm of separating church and state, they say, doesn't mean they should keep quiet on the major issues

facing congregations. The debate about whether religious leaders should wade into politics erupted again Tuesday when the Right Rev. Mariann Budde, the Episcopal bishop of Washington, D.C., made a public plea in a sermon before President Trump to show "mercy" to LGBTQ+ youth and immigrants living in the country illegally. Trump responded, saying in a post on his platform Truth Social that Budde "brought her

BISHOP, Page A6

Targeting DEI

The Trump administration ordered agencies to start closing their offices and officials to be put on leave. **A6.**

ICE arrests

Plan to allow them at schools, houses of worship criticized. **B1.**

Officials in sanctuary cities reject Justice Dept. warning

By Samantha J. Gross
GLOBE STAFF

Massachusetts political and law enforcement officials now face the threat of federal prosecution if they resist or fail to comply with the Trump administration's plan to arrest and deport undocumented immigrants living in their communities, according to a memo sent to employees of the Justice Department this week.

The department ordered federal prosecutors Tuesday to investigate state or local officials they believe are interfering with the Trump administration's crackdown on immigration, saying they could face criminal charges, in an apparent warning to the dozens of jurisdictions across the country with "sanctuary" policies or procedures.

One such community is Easthampton, whose mayor, Nicole LaChapelle, called the memo "chilling."

"We can affirm and pledge to stand with all of our resi-

SANCTUARY CITIES, Page A7

Weight-loss drugs highly popular in Mass.

Broad insurance coverage clears way for many to take pricey medications

By Jonathan Saltzman
and Scooty Nickerson
GLOBE STAFF

Despite its love of lobster rolls, clam chowder, and Dunkin', Massachusetts consistently boasts one of the lowest obesity rates in the country.

Even so, this relatively lean state had among the nation's biggest surges last year in residents taking blockbuster weight-loss drugs, and the trend shows no signs of abating.

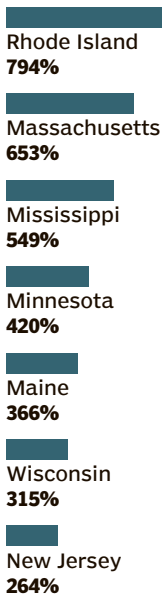
About 140,400 obese patients in Massachusetts were prescribed medications such as Wegovy and Zepbound in 2024, a 255 percent increase from 2023, according to a Globe analysis of insurance claims data compiled by Real Chemistry, a health analytics firm. That was the third-biggest jump of any state, behind Oklahoma and Rhode Island.

The steep increase was fueled by Massachusetts' broad insurance coverage of the pricey medicines, which are straining the budgets of insurers and employers but delivering life-changing results for many patients.

"I finally feel comfortable in my own skin — my joints don't hurt and exercise is much easier," said Kip Kransdorf, 60, a Sudbury manager-

OBESITY DRUGS, Page A10

Biggest increase in Medicaid spending on GLP-1s
Percentage increases calculated by comparing data from November 2023 to October 2024 with data from one year prior.



SOURCE: Real Chemistry
SCOOTY NICKERSON/GLOBE STAFF

High electric rates cool enthusiasm for heat pumps

By Sabrina Shankman
GLOBE STAFF

In five short years from now, Massachusetts aims to have at least a half-million homes running off heat pumps, those cutting-edge devices that can wrench energy from the air and convert it to heat or cool a building.

But there is a problem: Heat pumps are powered by electricity, and in Massachusetts, electric rates are among the highest in the nation.

When the temperature falls well below freezing, such as the deep cold of this week, some residents using heat pumps say their monthly electric bills soar — to as high as \$700 or more — because heat pumps are less efficient at low temperatures. While many homeowners say they're happy with their purchase and saw just slightly higher bills during cold months in recent years, others hit with big bills this winter say they're feeling buyer's remorse.

In Canton, Richard Sagotsky said his experience has been awful — though he takes some of the blame, opting for lower-cost heat pumps that were less efficient. Still, the bills during cold months are punishing, leaving him filled with regret. "I wanted to save the planet," he

HEAT PUMPS, Page A10



SUZANNE KREITER/GLOBE STAFF

Evan Weststrate of Newton said he's been happy with his switch to heat pumps.



PHOTOS BY JESSICA RINALDI/GLOBE STAFF

Areli (left) and two of her children, Yareli and Lucas, waited backstage before Yareli performed at a holiday dance recital.

WAITING AND WORRYING THAT CRACKDOWN WILL HIT HOME

An undocumented immigrant fears deportation could tear her family apart



President Trump is targeting people like Areli who have been ordered to leave the country in the past but have stayed.

By Giulia McDonnell Nieto del Rio
GLOBE STAFF

Areli's oldest son, 17-year-old Fabricio, made a promise to her Tuesday when he got home from school. If Areli were deported back to El Salvador, he told her, the whole family would go with her.

For Areli, a mother of three children in Boston, that scenario has been too painful to think about. Areli, who was raised in a household where domestic violence was common, and lacked access to much of a formal education, has worked hard to give her kids a life she never had. She pulls in 6-year-old Lucas often for gentle embraces, and calls her 9-year-old daughter Yareli "Princesa."

If immigration authorities arrested her, she would surely be separated from them, at least for some time. Areli has lived with this anxiety for years now, but her worry turned into dread after President Trump was sworn into office and began issuing orders to launch mass deportations of unauthorized immigrants.

"It's terrifying," Areli, 39, said Tuesday in Spanish. "What am I going to do? There are so many questions in my head."

Areli is one of about 200,000 unauthorized immigrants in

UNDOCUMENTED, Page A7

Governor Maura Healey released a \$62 billion budget that would include hundreds of millions of new funding for the MBTA and reshape parts of the state's tax code. B1.

Opponents of the White Stadium renovation plan aired their concerns at a marathon City Council hearing. B1.

A storm spread heavy snow, sleet, and freezing rain across the South, breaking records and giving the region an unaccustomed taste of winter. A2.

Israel pressed ahead with what it called a new counterterrorism operation in the West Bank, and Palestinian officials said at least 10 people were killed. A3.

Defrosted flakes

Thursday: Not as cold. High 30-35. Low 18-23.

Friday: About the same. High 27-32. Low 14-19.

Sunrise: 7:06 Sunset: 4:47
Weather and Comics, D5-6.

VOL. 307, NO. 23

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Suggested retail price
\$4.00



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